



△ Eurocopter EC135 1994

Origin France

Engine 2 x 434 shp Turbomeca Arrius B2B turboshaft

Top speed 178 mph (287 km/h)

This successful twin-engined police and EMS helicopter designed by MBB but improved by Eurocopter with fenestron and French turbines is the bestselling light twin of modern times.

▷ Eurocopter HH-65 Dolphin 1994

Origin French design/US built

Engine 2 x 853 shp Turbomeca Arriel 2C2-CG turboshaft

Top speed 190 mph (306 km/h)

This American-built version of Eurocopter AS365 Dauphin was used by the US Coast Guard for air-sea rescue. The original American engines were replaced with French turbines in 2004.



▷ Eurocopter EC120B Colibri 1998

Origin France

Engine 504 shp Turbomeca Arrius 2F turboshaft

Top speed 172 mph (277 km/h)

Eurocopter's entry-level helicopter, the Colibri, is renowned for low noise levels and passenger comfort. Used as a basic military trainer in France, it is also manufactured in Australia and China.



△ Messerschmitt-Boelkow-Blohm MBB Bo 105LS A3 Superlifter 1995

Origin Germany

Engine 2 x 650 shp Rolls-Royce 250-C30 turboshaft

Top speed 150 mph (241 km/h)

Forerunner of the EC135, the 105 was the smallest and least expensive twin-turbine helicopter. The 1995 variant included more powerful engines and improved rotor blades.



△ Kamov Ka-52 (Alligator) 1996

Origin Russia

Engine 2 x 2,200 shp Klimov TV3-117VK turboshaft

Top speed 196 mph (315 km/h)

Designed to replace the Mi-24 gunship, the Ka-52 had distinctive coaxial contra-rotating rotors. It was unusual in having an ejector seat—explosive bolts remove the rotors.



▽ Westland AH-64D Apache Longbow 1998

Origin UK (under US licence)

Engine 2 x 2,100 shp Rolls-Royce/Turbomeca RTM322 01/12 turboshaft

Top speed 182 mph (293 km/h)

As flown by Prince Harry in Afghanistan, the AH-64 was built in Britain from Boeing-provided kits. Some British versions had folding blades for shipboard operation.

